Receive and Verify Official Emergency Alerts

Use more than one way to receive warnings. Record local enrollment details only after the responsible agency verifies them.

! WARNING — URGENT ACTION

DRAFT — NOT READY FOR PUBLICATION. A local emergency-management representative must complete and sign the verification record below. Until then, no local system, enrollment link, telephone number, station, frequency, channel, call sign, or agency is endorsed here.

KNOW THE DIFFERENCE

Official emergency instructions

Messages issued by an authorized government public-safety agency may direct you to evacuate, shelter in place, avoid an area, or take another protective action. Follow the message and later updates from the issuing authority.

Neighborhood coordination

Neighbors may relay an official message, check on one another, or share observed conditions. They do **not** issue evacuation orders or replace 911, public-safety dispatch, or an authorized alerting agency.

SET UP LAYERED ALERTS

1. **Enable Wireless Emergency Alerts.** Check the emergency-alert settings on each compatible mobile phone. WEA alerts do not require enrollment; device, carrier, location, and settings affect receipt.
2. **Enroll in the verified local system.** Use only the exact address or telephone number entered and verified below. Add home, work, school, and caregiving locations when the official system permits.
3. **Add a non-cellular backup.** Choose a verified broadcast source, weather radio, landline notification, or a person who can relay official information.
4. **Make alerts accessible.** Set preferred languages and sound, vibration, caption, screen-reader, or other access features where available.
5. **Confirm before sharing.** Check the issuing agency and time. Use its official website or verified account; do not treat a screenshot or forwarded post as a new instruction.

Receive and Verify Official Emergency Alerts — continued

MY HOUSEHOLD ALERT RECORD

What to record	Household entry
Verified local alert system	_____
Exact enrollment URL	_____
Responsible agency	_____
Official information phone	_____
Broadcast station / frequency	_____
Radio channel / call sign (if officially assigned)	_____
Accessible or language option selected	_____
Backup person and method	_____
Last tested / reviewed	_____

Table 1: Monthly Expense Report

Household enrollment check:

Resident / device	Text	Voice	Email / app	Enrollment confirmed
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____
_____	☐	☐	☐	_____

Review enrollment after a phone number, email address, home, workplace, school, or caregiver changes. Keep account-recovery information secure, and do not assume enrollment guarantees delivery during a network failure.

⌖ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

Publication verification — required: I verified each completed local entry directly with the responsible agency and checked that the link reaches the agency-controlled enrollment page.

Agency representative: _____ **Title/unit:** _____
Verification method: _____ **Date:** _____
Binder reviewer: _____ **Signature/initials:** _____

SOURCES

General alerting guidance: Ready.gov, “Alerts and Warnings”; FEMA, “Wireless Emergency Alerts”; FCC, “Emergency Alert System.” Accessed September 25, 2026.